

CALIFORNIA LEGISLATURE—2025-2026 SIMULATION SESSION

SENATE BILL

NO [72](#)

Introduced by Senator Roger Niello

October 1st, 2025

This bill is an act to add Section 70904.5 to the Education Code, relating to workforce development.

LEGISLATIVE COUNSEL’S DIGEST

SB 72, as introduced, Niello. Public–Private Workforce Pipeline Act.

This bill would establish a statewide guideline intended to strengthen collaboration between public higher-education institutions and private employers in high-demand fields, with the goal of improving alignment between academic programs and workforce needs, expanding opportunities for work-based learning, and supporting student preparation for technical and professional careers. The bill preserves full institutional autonomy by providing that participation in any Public–Private Workforce Pipeline Partnership formed under the guideline is strictly voluntary for campuses of the University of California, the California State University, the California Community Colleges, and for employers.

Under existing law, the University of California, the California State University, and the California Community Colleges govern their own academic and workforce development programs. This bill would direct the Chancellor of the California State University and the President of the University of California, in coordination with the Chancellor’s Office of the California Community Colleges and with input from statewide and regional industry partners, to develop a general guideline to support voluntary Public–Private Workforce Pipeline Partnerships. The bill would authorize the guideline to include recommended practices related to employer consultation, curriculum input, and work-based learning, and would require the three segments to provide a joint annual update to the Legislature summarizing voluntary partnership activity and available outcomes. The bill would be implemented using existing resources to the extent feasible.

This bill creates a voluntary statewide guideline to help colleges and employers collaborate on workforce-aligned programs while preserving full institutional autonomy and requiring no new spending.

Vote: majority. Appropriation: no. Fiscal Committee: yes. Local Program: no

THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA DO ENACT AS FOLLOWS:

SECTION 1. Section 70904.5 is added to the Education Code, to read:

70904.5. (a) The Chancellor of the California State University and the President of the University of California, working in coordination with the Chancellor's Office of the California Community Colleges and with input from statewide and regional industry partners, shall develop a general framework to support the creation of Public-Private Workforce Pipeline

(b) For purposes of this section:

(1) "Public-Private Workforce Pipeline Partnership" means a voluntary cooperative effort between one or more campuses of the California State University or the University of California and one or more private employers to support, develop, or enhance certificate or degree programs aligned with regional labor-market needs. Community colleges may participate as supporting partners in such efforts.

(2) "High-demand fields" include, but are not limited to, healthcare, information technology, engineering, advanced manufacturing, and the skilled trades.

(3) "Priority interview opportunity" means that an employer choosing to participate in a partnership may agree to offer an interview to any graduate of a certificate or degree program developed under this section who meets the employer's minimum qualifications.

(c) The guideline developed pursuant to subdivision (a) may include recommended practices for the formation of Public-Private Workforce Pipeline Partnerships, intended to strengthen alignment between academic programs and regional workforce needs, including:

(1) Curriculum developed or informed jointly by faculty of the University of California or the California State University, in collaboration with participating employers and, where applicable, with input from community colleges.

(2) Opportunities for on-site training, internships, clinical placements, practicums, or apprenticeships, as appropriate for the field.

(3) employer commitments, including to provide priority interview opportunities to qualified program graduates.

(d) The Chancellor of the California State University, the President of the University of California, and the Chancellor's Office of the California Community Colleges shall jointly publish an annual update to the Legislature summarizing:

(1) The number and types of voluntary partnerships established statewide.

(2) The number of students enrolled in, and completing, programs connected to voluntary partnerships.

(3) Available job placement or workforce outcome data for participating graduates.

(4) Levels of employer participation and feedback from participating partners.

(e) Nothing in this section shall be construed to require new appropriations. The Chancellor of the California State University, the President of the University of California, and the Chancellor's Office of the California Community Colleges may utilize existing resources to carry out the provisions of this act to the extent feasible.

SEC. 2. Effective Date.

This act shall take effect beginning with the 2026–27 academic year.